

Ozzie the Otter's Lost Pebble

An original bedtime story for ages 4–7. Reading time: about 4 minutes.



Kids Book Videos



Ozzie was a playful river otter. He lived by the sparkling stream. Ozzie had a favorite pebble. It was smooth and gray. It had a white stripe. Ozzie juggled it every day. Toss, catch, toss, catch! He kept it in a secret nook. It was his treasure.



One morning, Ozzie went to his nook. The pebble was gone! He looked under the leaves. No pebble. He looked behind the rocks. No pebble. Ozzie felt worried. His whiskers drooped. "My lucky pebble is lost!" he cried. He felt sad. A tear plopped into the stream.



His friend Tammy the terrapin swam over. Terrapins are excellent divers. "Why the long face, Ozzie?" asked Tammy. "I lost my pebble," said Ozzie. "It had a white stripe." "It was my favorite." Tammy smiled kindly. "Then we will search together," she said. "Treasure is sweeter when found together." "Treasure is sweeter when found together." Ozzie repeated it softly. "Treasure is sweeter when found together." It became their searching song. "Treasure is sweeter when found together."



First, they searched the shallow pool. Ozzie dove down. Tammy dove deeper. They peeked under every stone. No pebble. Next, they searched the sandy bank. Ozzie dug with his paws. Dig dig dig. Tammy sifted the sand. No pebble. Ozzie felt like crying. But Tammy said, "Treasure is sweeter when found together." So they searched one more place. The little waterfall pool. Ozzie dove under the bubbles. And there it was! The smooth gray pebble with the white stripe. It had washed downstream. "FOUND IT!" shouted Ozzie. He felt overjoyed. He felt relieved. He hugged Tammy tight.



Can you dive like Ozzie? Take a deep breath. Now dive! Look left, look right. Found it! Ozzie juggled his pebble all afternoon. Toss, catch, toss, catch! Tammy clapped her flippers. Ozzie gave Tammy a turn. She juggled it too. They laughed and splashed. The pebble was even more special now. "Treasure is sweeter when found together," they sang. Ozzie felt thankful. He felt happy.



When the sun set, the stream turned golden. Ozzie placed his pebble in the nook. Tammy curled on a warm rock. "Thank you for searching with me," whispered Ozzie. "Anytime, treasure friend," said Tammy. Ozzie closed his eyes. He heard the stream babbling softly. Bubble, splash, sleep. The moon shimmered on the water. And Ozzie drifted into a peaceful sleep.

Moral: *Searching together makes finding even more joyful.*

The End